

Personal Information

Name: Dr. Koushik Chowdhury [LinkedIn](#)
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PROFILE

I am integrated geographer with expertise in socio-ecological systems research. I typically employ mixed methods approaches—a combination of qualitative, quantitative, and participatory methods—to comprehend intricate human-environment interactions. My research interests focused on sustainability sciences which include sustainable resource management, climate adaptation, and nature-based solutions.

Education

01.2015-10.2021 **PhD.**
Natural resource management
Indian Institute of Technology Kharagpur, Kharagpur, WB, India
Thesis Title: *Traditional Water Bodies, Ecosystem Services and Sustainable Natural Resource Conservation in West Bengal, India*

08.2009-04.2011 **Masters of Arts (MA)**
Geography
Vidyasagar University, Midnapur, WB, India

05.2006-06.2009 **Bachelor of Arts (BA)**
Geography (Hons)
Hijli College, Vidyasagar University, Kharagpur, WB, India

Research Interests

Socio-ecological interaction	Nature based solutions	Landscape management
Political ecology	Climate change adaptation	Environmental Policy analysis
Ecosystem services and values	Water governance and management	

Teaching Interests

My teaching interests lie at the intersection of rural development, environmental studies, Human Geography and participatory research. I am passionate about designing and delivering interdisciplinary courses to address sustainability challenges. I aim to develop courses such as *Participatory Research Methods, Agroecosystems and Ecosystem Services, Geography for Rural Development, Landscape Governance, and Justice and Equity in Rural sustainability*.

Research Experiences

03.2023- 03.2025 **Post-Doctoral Fellow: URBAN NBS Project**
Alexander von Humboldt Fellowship
University of Kassel, Germany

- Investigating the role of blue infrastructure on urban sustainability using Nature-Based Solutions and Nature future approaches, comparative analysis among the quality of waterscape and across cities.
- Interdisciplinary research, project management, stakeholder engagement, household survey.
- Utilized KoboCollect Toolbox for socio-economic data collection and field data management.
- Conducted quantitative data analysis, applying multivariate analysis and regression modelling.
- Performed qualitative data analysis using MaxQDA, including thematic and content analysis.

- 01.2022-12.2022 Research Associate: MIGRATION Project**
Indian Institute of Technology Kharagpur
- Investigating the socio-economic impact of COVID-19 migration in the Sundarbans region using geo-spatial analytics, funded by DST, New Delhi.
 - Designed and executed structured questionnaires, field surveys, focus group discussions, key informant interviews, and case studies for data collection and stakeholder analysis.
 - Applied advance quantitative analysis- Regression modelling and multivariate analysis for data analysis.
 - Used GIS for Change detection analysis of land surface.
- 08.2014-02.2015 Research Associate: TANK Project**
Indian Institute of Technology Kharagpur
- Investigating the role of sustainable use and management of traditional water harvesting systems in Odisha and West Bengal sponsored by ICSSR, New Delhi.
 - Designed and executed questionnaire preparation, field survey, focus group discussion, key informant interview for data collections and stakeholder analysis
 - Statistical analysis-multivariate analysis

Teaching Experiences

- 01.2026-Present Assistant Professor**
Department of Development Studies
Vivekananda Global University
Jaipur, Rajasthan.
- 11.2011-06.2013 Guest Lecturer (UG)**
Department of Geography,
Silda C S College, Silda, Paschim Medinipur, West Bengal, India

Research Funding

- 2026 Project Title:** Thirthscape: Linking Household Water Insecurity, Coping Strategies, and Everyday Well-Being in Peri-Urban Jaipur
Duration: 01.03.2026-31.03.2027
Investigators: Koushik Chowdhury (PI), Dr. Manisha (Co-PI)
Funder: Seed Fund Scheme, Vivekananda Global University [Amount: 97500 INR]
Research organization: Vivekananda Global University, Jaipur

Peer Review Publications:

- 2026**
16. **Chowdhury, K.**, Thapa, P., Topp, E., Nagendra, H., Pereira, P and Plieninger, T. 2026. Unpacking the intrinsic, instrumental, and relational values of urban waterscapes for sustainability: Local perspectives from four Indian megacities. *Ecosystems and People*.
 15. Pramanik, M., Manna, H., and **Chowdhury, K.**, 2026. Reaping the Cost of Expansion: How Rapid Urbanization in Bangkok is Reducing Ecosystem Services. *Urban Ecosystems*. 29, 78. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11252-026-01920-w>
- 2025**
14. Zafra-Calvo, N., Altmann B.A., **Chowdhury, K.**, Cortés-Capano, G., Flinzberger, L., Heindorf, C., Huber, J.M., Jay, M., Kmoch, L., Polas A.B., Svobodova, K., Thapa, P., Plieninger, T. 2025. Engaging with justice in Integrated Landscape Approaches. *Ecology and Society*. <https://doi.org/10.5751/ES-16265-300306>

13. Chi, W., **Chowdhury, K.**, Lin, G., Topp, E., and Plieninger, T., 2025. Informing adaptive governance of agricultural heritage landscapes under structural changes – the role of values, rules and knowledge. *Sustainability Science*. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11625-024-01617-z>
12. **Chowdhury, K.**, Basu, S., Pramanik, M., and Plieninger, T. 2025. Blue Infrastructure as Nature-based Solutions for Urban Sustainability: Evaluating Local Perceptions from four Indian Megacities. *Nature-based Solutions*. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.nbsj.2025.100211>

2024

11. Tun, K. Z., Pramanik, M., Chakraborty, R., **Chowdhury, K.**, Halder, B., Pande, C. B., Mukhopadhyay, A., and Zhran, M. 2024. Mainstreaming Nature-Based Solutions for Climate Adaptation in Southeast Asia: A Systematic Review. *Earth Systems and Environment*. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s41748-024-00473-2>
- 10 Thapa, P., Torralba M, Nölke, N., **Chowdhury, K.**, Nagendra, H., and Plieninger T. 2024. Disentangling associations of human wellbeing with green infrastructure, degree of urbanity, and social factors around an Asian megacity. *Landscape Ecology*. 39(8), p-152. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10980-024-01937-6>
9. Chi, W., Plieninger, T., Lin, G., and **Chowdhury, K.** 2024. Governing Landscape Simplification in Rapid Commercialization Contexts – the Case of the Dike-Pond System in the Pearl River Delta, China. *International Journal of the Commons*, 18(1), p. 260–275. <https://doi.org/10.5334/ijc.1300>

2023

8. Behera, B., **Chowdhury, K.**, Mishra, T, and Rahut D. B. 2023. Climate Variability, Rainwater-Harvesting Structures and Groundwater Levels in Odisha, India: an Empirical Analysis, *International Journal of Water Resources Development*. <https://doi.org/10.1080/07900627.2023.2279962>

2022

7. **Chowdhury, K** and Behera, B. 2022. Institutional Dynamics and Water Resource Management: Case of Traditional Water Bodies in West Bengal, India. *International Journal of Water Resources Development*. 38:5. 836-860. <https://doi.org/10.1080/07900627.2021.1916448>

2021

6. **Chowdhury, K** and Behera, B. 2021. Traditional Water Bodies and Cultural Ecosystem Services: Experiences from West Bengal, India. *World Development Perspectives*, 24. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.wdp.2021.100372>
5. **Chowdhury, K** and Behera, B. 2021. Economic significance of provisioning ecosystem services of traditional water bodies: empirical evidences from West Bengal, India. *Resources, Environment and Sustainability*, 5. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.resenv.2021.100033>

2020

4. **Chowdhury, K** and Behera, B. 2020. Traditional Water Bodies and Ecosystem Services: Empirical Evidence from West Bengal, India. *Natural Resources Forum*, 44: 1–17. <https://doi.org/10.1111/1477-8947.12196>
3. Pramanik, M., **Chowdhury, K.**, Rana, M.J., Bisht, P., Pal, R., Szabo, S., Pal, I., Behera, B., Liang, Q., Padmadas, S.S. and Udmale, P. 2020. Climatic influence on the magnitude of COVID-19 outbreak: a stochastic model-based global analysis. *International Journal of Environmental Health Research*. 32:5, 1095-1110. <https://doi.org/10.1080/09603123.2020.1831446>
2. Pramanik, M., Udmale, P., Bisht, P., **Chowdhury, K.**, Szabo S., and Pal, I. 2020. Climatic factors influence the spread of COVID-19 in Russia. *International Journal of Environmental Health Research*. 32:4, 723-737. <https://doi.org/10.1080/09603123.2020.1793921>

2018

1. **Chowdhury, K** and Behera, B. 2018. Is declining groundwater levels linked with the discontinuity of traditional water harvesting systems (tank irrigation)? Empirical evidence from West Bengal, India. *Groundwater for Sustainable Development*, 7: 185-194. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.gsd.2018.05.007>

Curriculum Development

Redesigned and updated the BA and MA Geography curricula, including the development of four new courses in contemporary areas of Geography:

- Fundamentals of Sustainability Studies (UG, 3 Credits)
- Indigenous Knowledge Systems (IKS): Land, Culture, and Sustainability (UG, 2 Credit)
- Development Geography and Policies in India (UG, 4 Credit)
- Geographies of Development and Sustainability (PG, 3 Credit)

Memberships

- Development Studies Association (UK)

Software Skills

- **Statistical Analysis:** STATA, R, SPSS, Minitab
- **Qualitative Analysis:** MaxQDA
- **Productivity & Documentation:** MS Office (Word, Excel, PowerPoint), Visio

Awards and Fellowships

2023-2025	Alexander von Humboldt Postdoc Fellowship, Alexander von Humboldt Stiftung,
2019	Travel grants to attend the 8th ICCG conference in Athens, Greece.
2013	Junior Research Fellowship, CSIR, with all India Rank 22nd. UGC NET, University Grants Commission, Govt. of India.
2012	UGC NET, University Grants Commission, Govt. of India.

Editorial Roles / Professional Service

Associate Editor	SN Social Sciences (Human geography), Springer Nature
Academic Editor	PLOS One (Human Geography, Applied ecology and resource management, Ethnobiology), Public Library of Science (PLOS).
Academic Editor	PLOS Sustainability and Transformation , Public Library of Science (PLOS).

Paper Presented in Conferences:

- 2026: Presented a paper at the conference on *Redefining Rural Development* in Vivekananda Global University, Jaipur.
- 2026: Presented a paper at the *IMASEE* conference in Vivekananda Global University, Jaipur.
- 2026: Presented a paper at the *ANUBHUTI4.0* in Vivekananda Global University, Jaipur.
- 2024: Presented a paper at the 5th ESP Europe Conference in Wageningen, Netherland.
- 2019: Presented a paper at the 8th International Conference on Critical Geography 2019 (ICCG) in Athens, Greece.
- 2019: Presented a paper at “ANUSANDHAN” in Indian Institute of Forest Management Bhopal, India.
- 2018: Presented a paper at 25th ASBBS conference in Las Vegas, NV, USA

- 2018: Presented a paper at 22nd IPEA Conference in Department of Economics, Jammu University, Jammu, India.
- 2017: Presented a paper at the International Conference in Department of Geography and Resource Management, Mizoram University, India.
- 2017: Presented the proposal at the 10th Doctoral Thesis Conference, in IBS Hyderabad, India.

Workshop Attended:

- 2019: Qualitative Methods for Research in Socially Inclusive and Sustainable Agricultural Intensification at IIT Kharagpur, India.
- 2019: Rural Water Quality Management at IIT Kharagpur, India.
- 2018: Managing and Governing Resource in the Anthropocene: Political Ecological Explorations from South Asia at IIT Kharagpur, India.
- 2018: Climate Change Risk on Sustainable Development in Rural India (Fact, Friction, Policy)” at IIT Kharagpur, India.
- 2017: Quantitative Research Methods in Social Sciences Using SPSS at IDSK, Kolkata, India.
- 2016: Applied Economic Tools and Techniques for Managing Environmental Resources at TERI University, India.
- 2016: Research Skill and Data Analysis using R at CUSAT, Cochin, India.
- 2013: Theory and Application of Geospatial, geo-Imaging & Remote Sensing Technology at IIT Kharagpur, India.

Academic Referees:

Provide upon request

Declarations:

I do hereby declare that all the above information is true to the best of my knowledge.

Date: September 15, 2026

Place: Jaipur, India

Koushik Chowdhury

Signature